

From Housewife to Maize Maven: Kanchana's Triumph over Adversity in Rural Sri Lanka

Kanchana's life story is a remarkable example of resilience, determination, and the power of seizing opportunities in the harsh and sun-scorched lands of Kitulutuwa, Agbopura in Sri Lanka. She started her journey as a humble housewife and has now become a successful farmer and entrepreneur in maize cultivation. Kanchana's story reflects the spirit of perseverance and the importance of community support.

Kanchana was motivated to contribute to her community's agricultural projects and found an opportunity through the JSB project, which was supported by the UNDP and the Sri Lanka Red Cross Society. Despite facing several challenges due to the arid climate of the region, she was determined to grow maize for poultry feed. With the support of the project, Kanchana embarked on this journey and worked hard to achieve her goals.

Kanchana was undeterred by the harsh conditions as she meticulously tended to her one-acre plot of land. She utilized innovative techniques, such as the sprinkle water system provided by the project, to achieve her goal. Her hard work and dedication eventually paid off as she defied the odds and harvested an impressive yield of maize seeds.

Kanchana has achieved success not only in the fields but also in striking a profitable deal at the nearby poultry feed production center in Aluth Oya. As a result, she has earned a 120,000 LKR net profit. Encouraged by this success, she is now planning to expand her maize cultivation and reinvest her earnings in further agricultural endeavors.

Kanchana has adopted the practice of intercropping, which involves growing two or more crops simultaneously on the same land. By mixing vegetables, fruits, and legumes, she aims to increase the yield of her farm while promoting sustainability and resilience in the face of challenges. Her goals are not solely focused on financial gain but also on her desire to feel empowered and independent as a farmer and a woman. She is determined to reach her full potential in both areas.

Kanchana's story is an inspiring example for her community, demonstrating the transformative power of perseverance, hard work, and support from loved ones. With hope and determination, Kanchana remains dedicated to her journey towards prosperity, driven by her passion for agriculture and her unwavering spirit of resilience. Her pioneering efforts leave behind a legacy of inspiration and success to inspire others to follow her lead.